The Black Veil bible, final draft v3

The Black Veil: bible, final draft v3

For your read before you pick the five survivors. Nothing here changes the live site. Date of the party: Friday 23 October 2026, doors 8:00 PM.

0. Where things stand

You approved: the Succession plan; the pairs and the affair; the secrets; the overall winner by points; the receipts; the wall pieces; the background summary on every card; the real objects.

You picked the survivors: Mihir, Rhea, Adam, Anthony and Molly. Section 11 lists what has to adjust. **Still open (yours):** OK on those adjustments, the point values (placeholders below), and what is on the drinks menu.

Is Cassie's pin and the dial real? No, they are story only. They appear on paper (the vault memorandum, the old man's jacket note, one of the questions) and nobody opens anything at the party. If you want a prop, a lapel pin taped to the portrait frame is enough.

1. The story in plain words

1924. Cassie Castello runs the Black Veil, a supper club above the Merrimack, opened December 1921. Kit Kessler, the Keeper, keeps its books. The Mahns family are the silent partners. In the autumn of 1924 federal pressure is closing in, so Cassie plans the **Exit**: a staged massacre on All Hallows' Eve, so the Veil's twenty-two people can vanish with new names and a payout from the vault. Adam sells her the blanks, Luke builds the stage blood.

At 11:02 four go up to the private landing (Cassie, Kit, the Silent Partner, the Notary) and the Exit is witnessed. At 11:30 the "massacre" happens and the guests flee to the papers. At 11:47 the music stops, Kit signs out, and he leaves with Cassie by the river door. At the launch he **ambushes her**, takes the books, and she escapes wounded to Rebecca's boarding house (Room 3). Kit pays Rebecca $200 to forget her.

Kit tells the scattered members that Cassie is finished. On 4 November he prepares **the List** of the twenty-two, and on the 8th he hires a hitman, Quill, paying him out of the Teller's own share. Between December 1924 and September 1925 seventeen of them die in "accidents." Three orders "in Cassie's hand" are shown to a court, and receipts in her name come from Kit's bank: all forged by the Notary under threat, in a hand that rings its i's. **Five could not be found.** On 30 September 1925 Quill reports all twenty-two settled but cannot show five. In October 1925 the five find Quill first and kill him, and they go under new names. Cassie, hiding in Montreal, paid for their escape. Her Christmas card comes that December.

1926. On 22 October Kit returns to Manchester and asks the Butler for the Merrimack Room and a rye at nine o'clock. **He has sent invitations to the 19 regular guests**, because he holds a secret on every one of them. Cassie, from Montreal, has sent each of **the five survivors** a separate, unsigned invitation with a numbered marker. They know they have to end him. Why is theirs to learn.

The Succession, his plan. At half past nine, after his nightcap, Kit means to crown himself the new head of the Black Veil before the 19 as witnesses (the black satin cloth is the Veil). He needs them to do it: the Sheriff swears him in, the Judge signs the charter, the Doctor certifies that Cassie is dead, the Lawyer files it, the Newsie and the radio announcer print and

broadcast it, the Butler hands over the House. Their secrets are the leash. What he still lacks is Cassie's pin and the dial for the vault. He does not know the five are in the room.

The night. The House sells its single vial to the first survivor with a marker. At nine the nightcap is served. At 9:15 the Butler finds the old man dead and screams. Whoever bought the vial is the killer and, at the end, is **crowned the new head of the Black Veil**.

2. Timeline

When	What
Dec 1921	Cassie opens the Black Veil. Kit keeps the books. The Mahns family is the Silent Partner
Oct 1924	Federal pressure builds. Cassie plans the Exit
31 Oct 1924, 22:10	The orchestra is admitted at the river door
31 Oct 1924, 23:02	Cassie, Kit, the Silent Partner and the Notary go up to the landing: the Exit is witnessed
31 Oct 1924, 23:30	The staged massacre. Guests flee and tell the papers
31 Oct 1924, 23:47	The music stops. Kit signs out. He ambushes Cassie at the launch. She escapes to Rebecca's, wounded
1 Nov 1924	The Farrago runs "massacre." Kit tells the members Cassie is finished, pays Rebecca $200 to forget Room 3
4 and 8 Nov 1924	Kit prepares the List of twenty-two. Quill is retained
Dec 1924 – Sep 1925	Seventeen "accidents." Forged orders and receipts blame Cassie
3 Mar 1925	The Wren's aeroplane falls into Lake Massabesic. Cal Yates dies
30 Sep 1925	Quill reports all twenty-two settled; he cannot show five
Oct 1925	The five find Quill first and kill him. Two memorial notices (Crane, Ballard) are placed and withdrawn
22 Dec 1925	Cassie's Christmas card, postmarked Manchester
7 Oct 1926	Black envelopes arrive. A Montreal wire asks WHO PREPARED THE LIST
22 Oct 1926	Kit returns and asks the Butler for the Merrimack Room and a rye at nine
23 Oct 1926	The party

3. The cast (24 characters, plus you)

Five groups. Each holds one survivor; a survivor is ranked with the other four for the group result, but the overall winner is whoever has the most points.

Character	Role	Group	What they do	Carries
Anika Mahns of Mahns Manor	Heir	The Gilded	Sneaky deal with Silas. Wears her father's brass key on a ribbon	metal spoon
J. Bruce Wayne	Wealthy playboy	The Gilded		—
Mihir Nagarkatti of Nag Oil	Oil master	The Gilded		—
Rhea Mallya of Mallya's Emporium	Department store owner	The Gilded	Swap with Tim	napkin

Character	Role	Group	What they do	Carries
Krrish Vermouth	Wine importer	The Gilded	Affair seeker. Swap with Anika	the key you dig up
Sheriff Theodor Farrago	Sheriff	Order & Letters	The Sheriff: badge, black cowboy hat, handcuffs. Holds the citation for Leon (the pardon). Arrests by 10:15	—
Judge Eric Leeway	Judge	Order & Letters	Deal with Molly (early verdict tip)	—
Anthony Hung, Esq.	Defense attorney	Order & Letters		—
Dr. Emmerich Sunner	Doctor	Order & Letters	The Doctor: examines the body and the glass	—
Molly Daniel of the Manchester Union	Newsie	The Wire & the Stage	Deal with Eric. Prints the Extra	—
Leon Gee of WFEA	Radio announcer	The Wire & the Stage	The pardon: pays a go-between so Theodor drops the citation	—
Ananya Codru and Charlie Wakem	Night telegraph office	The Wire & the Stage	Affair with Luke (hide). Swap with Erika	printed telegram form
Luke Shelldon	Carnival barker	The Wire & the Stage	Affair with Ananya (hide). Swap with Angelos	giraffe whittling
Silas Palmer of the Palm Court	Jazz scat singer	The Wire & the Stage	Sneaky deal with Anika. Five-minute spotlight at 8:30	—
Joshua Kamin-Sky	Soothsayer	The Working Folk	The Soothsayer's two jobs (below). Swap with Tiffany. Finds the star-marked kosher salt (it stays in place)	something you will find
Arjun Bat	Slugger	The Working Folk	Swap with Adam	baseball
Adam Holdsfire	Gunsmith	The Working Folk	Swap with Arjun	the little brown box
Tiffany Liu of the Lamps	Stained-glass artist	The Working Folk	Go-between for the pardon (first choice). Swap with Josh	an earring
Diwakar Sandbagg	Prizefighter	The Working Folk	Finds the golden dumbbell	—
Tim McGinley, Baron of Bathtub Gin	Gin baron	The River Trade	Swap with Rhea	the little jar
Rebecca Chow, Butler of the Black Veil	Butler	The River Trade	The Butler: House Tin, House Book, the one vial. Planned alibi from Erika. Screams at 9:15	—
Angelos Bowles	Card sharp	The River Trade	Affair seeker. Swap with Luke	casino chip
Erika Lamm	Fugitive	The River Trade	Gives Rebecca her alibi. Swap with Ananya	printed false papers
Sidd Airwind	Barnstormer	The River Trade		—
Bartend Joe	Bartender (you)	host	Serves drinks, stages the scene, never a suspect, scores nothing	—

The pairs and mechanics:

- **Ananya and Luke:** the one secret affair (they hide it). Seekers: Angelos, Krrish, Rhea. Charlie shares Ananya's card, so he will read this.
- **Leon and Theodor, the pardon (our old bribe-and-payoff mechanic):** Leon mocks the Sheriff on the radio, and Theodor suspects an unlicensed second transmitter (the same one that sends Cassie's "I am well" items). Theodor holds a one-use citation for Leon. Leon can pay a go-between at least $50 in fake bills (Tiffany first, or Eric or Rebecca), who hands Theodor a pardon slip. Theodor chooses: serve the citation (small reward) or take the bribe (bigger reward). Leon and the go-between score when it goes through. It never touches the murder scoring.
- **Anika and Silas, the sneaky deal:** Anika wants to know who in the room knew her father, the Silent Partner. She pays Silas $30 to play her father's signature tune at 8:30 and say it was a request. Silas gets a five-minute spotlight. They both note who stops, hums or leaves, and neither may admit the deal.
- **Erika and Rebecca, the planned alibi:** Erika swears she was with Rebecca at 9:15, so the Butler who finds the body is not suspected. Rebecca already sells alibis at $20.
- **Eric and Molly, the leak:** he tips her a verdict a day early, and she prints it as news. *(With Molly a survivor this becomes Eric and Krrish: Krrish sends the Judge a crate of wine every Friday and the Judge quietly dismisses his cases. Neither may admit it.)*

Josh's role, the Soothsayer. Two jobs, neither of which gives anything away alone. (1) *The prophecy:* before 8:30 he writes down the exact minute he thinks the scream will come, and you seal it in an envelope and open it at 9:15. (2) *The fortunes:* you give him a deck of twelve fortune cards. Each is a cryptic true hint, a partial clue about a different fact, and he has to read the fortunes of four guests. Each guest keeps the card, and it counts as a printed page.

4. What every guest is told

The card summary (every card, top of page):

> **THE BLACK VEIL** *A private supper club above the Merrimack. Members only. Secrets extra.*
>
> **All Hallows' Eve, 1924.** The masquerade was the talk of Manchester, right up until the music stopped. The orchestra slipped in by the river door. Four masked guests slipped up to the private landing. By midnight the papers were screaming *massacre*, and nobody could find a body, a name, or a coroner willing to sign for one. The proprietress, Miss Cassie Castello, had vanished with the last dance.
>
> **The year after.** A police bulletin called Cassie "a person of interest," and then lost interest. Seventeen people with no records and no relatives met unfortunate accidents. Nobody added it up. (You may.)
>
> **Tonight.** The black envelopes came to your door, signed by nobody you would dare name. You came anyway. Curious. A little reckless. Wear it well. Before the night is through, someone will be found dead, and the rest of you will have opinions.
>
> **Five ghosts in the room.** Five souls the papers swore were lost are here tonight in borrowed names and borrowed faces, sipping your drinks and watching your hands. They are guests like you. Before the lights come up you may point at up to five of your fellow guests and say *ghost*. Be right and it pays. Be wrong and it stings.
>
> **Last call.** You will be asked three things: what really happened in 1924, who did it tonight and how, and who the dead man was to the Veil.
>
> **A word to the ghosts.** If you are one of the five, your private page already knows. Everyone else's has the same sealed flap with nothing behind it. Nobody can tell by looking. Keep a straight face.

Nothing in it gives the time of the body, the old man, the vault or the plan.

The envelopes. Everyone gets the same black envelope. The 19 find the House's invitation inside. The five find Cassie's unsigned invitation (it ends "The veil lifts") and their numbered marker. The outsides are identical, so the envelope proves nothing.

The House's asks. The House's invitation also gives seven of the 19 a private line telling them what they will be asked to do at half past nine: the Sheriff to swear him in, the Judge to sign the charter, the Doctor to certify a death, the Lawyer to file the charter, the Newsie and the radio announcer to print and broadcast it, the Butler to hand over the House. None of them is told why. Nobody brings anything: you lay out a Bible, the court seal, a blank certificate, a blank charter, a blank headline and a blank bulletin on the black table before the doors open. Put together, the lines are the Succession.

5. The mysteries, with the answers

Three mysteries are worth 100 points; everyone's errands are worth 60. Whoever finishes every errand and never works out the story cannot win.

#	Question	Points	The answer
Old 1	What really happened at the Black Veil in 1924?	10	It was staged: stage blood, blanks, a show. Nobody died. Cassie planned it
Old 2	Why did the members leave with Cassie?	10	New names, to be thought dead, and a payout from the vault. They trusted her
Old 3	Who killed the members afterward, and how did it look like someone else did it?	10	Kit Kessler, through a hired hitman. Forged orders and receipts blamed Cassie
New 1	Who poisoned the Keeper?	16	The survivor who bought the vial from the Butler
New 2	How was he poisoned, and where did the poison come from?	12	Strychnine (nux vomica) in his nightcap rye, sold by the Butler from the House's stock
New 3	Why did the killer do it?	12	The killer's own grievance (what Kit took from them)
Connection 1	Who was the dead man to the Veil, and what had he done?	10	Kit Kessler, the Keeper. He prepared the List, had members killed, ousted Cassie
Connection 2	How do the five survivors connect to him?	10	They are the five who escaped his hitman and came to end him
Connection 3	Who sent the invitations, and why?	10	**Changed:** Kit sent the 19, to be witnesses to his Succession. Cassie sent the five, to finish him

The two replacement questions for the killer and the Butler. The Butler knows who bought the vial and the killer knows who poured it, so New 1 and New 2 would be free for them. Both answer these instead, with no automatic points for anyone:

- **Question A (16, instead of New 1):** *What did the Keeper come to the Black Veil to do tonight, and how did he mean to do it?* Answer: crown himself the new head of the Black Veil at half past nine, before the 19 as witnesses (6); their secrets were his leash and each had to sign (5); Cassie had to be declared dead so the vault and books would pass to him (5). It does not include the five, since he does not know they are there.
- **Question B (12, instead of New 2):** *Where are the Keeper's books, and what does it take to open them?* Answer: in the vault behind the Merrimack Room's second window (4); three keys, the Keeper's ring, the Silent Partner's brass key and Cassie's diamond pin (5); then a dial only Cassie sets (3).

The tie-breaker: a secret clue, earned only if needed. Nothing about it is on any card or in the rules. Hidden in the lining of the dead man's jacket is a second rail stub that no errand points at: *Manchester to Boston, 23 October, 11:12 PM, one way.* (He meant to be gone right after crowning himself.) Only if two or more guests tie on total points does the final form show those guests one extra question, and only to them: *"At what time did the Keeper's train out of Manchester leave?"* Only someone who searched the jacket lining knows: 11:12. It is worth zero points and just breaks the tie. If nobody gets it, or several do, the next rule applies. The full order: total points; mystery points; the secret tie-breaker; the "who" question (Question A for the killer and the Butler); survivors correctly named; errands; printed pages found; who finished first. A last hash makes sure there is exactly one winner. I add the question and the stub to the code when I load the rest.

Other points (current values, placeholders): each printed page filed is worth 2 (cap 12); each survivor named right is +4 and wrong is −2 (capped at +20 and −10); a survivor who stays hidden earns up to 20; the killer's bonus is currently a flat +6 in the code; it becomes +1 above the next-best survivor, as you decided (the killer is one point above their group).

6. Can everyone solve it? The clue map

Every fact below is held by at least three people, and nobody holds enough to solve it alone. Each person's card carries 3 to 9 clue lines. The tool that checks this (`npm run game:check`) passes all 21 checks today. It has to be re-run once the changes below are loaded.

Fact the guests must piece together	Held by (lines on their cards)	Printed pages
The massacre was staged (stage blood, blanks, no coroner)	Luke Shelldon, Adam Holdsfire, Dr. Emmerich Sunner, Molly Daniel	The Farrago, 1 November 1924
The Exit was Cassie's plan: be thought dead, take a new name, get paid from the vault	Rebecca Chow, Anthony Hung, Erika Lamm, Anika Mahns	A torn register page, 31 October 1924
Kit ambushed Cassie at the river launch and took the books	Joshua Kamin-Sky, Leon Gee, Tim McGinley, Rebecca Chow	A torn register page, 31 October 1924, A boarding-house page, November 1924
Kit hired a hitman who settled seventeen	Krrish (takes Jack's line), Adam Holdsfire, Sheriff Theodor Farrago, Dr. Emmerich Sunner	Receipts: A. Quill
The orders blaming Cassie were forged (ringed i's)	Rebecca Chow, Anthony Hung, Ananya Codru and Charlie Wakem, Leon Gee	Three “orders” in C.C.'s hand, Cassie's Christmas card, 1925
Cassie is alive, in Montreal	Leon Gee, Rebecca Chow, Ananya Codru and Charlie Wakem	Cassie's Christmas card, 1925, The October wire
A vault holds the real books: three keys and a dial only Cassie sets	Anika Mahns, Adam Holdsfire, Joshua Kamin-Sky, Arjun Bat	Memorandum: the vault, Books, extract 1923
The dead man is Kit Kessler, the Keeper	Rebecca Chow, Anika Mahns, Anthony Hung, Tiffany Liu	The pocket watch, Rent counterfoils, A rail stub
He takes a rye with honey at nine	Rebecca Chow, Mihir Nagarkatti, Molly Daniel, Anika Mahns	The nightcap chart
Strychnine (nux vomica) in the rye	Dr. Emmerich Sunner, Adam Holdsfire, Sheriff Theodor Farrago, Rhea Mallya	The Coroner's report, The empty vial
The House's own vial, sold once to a marker	Rebecca Chow, Tim McGinley, Angelos Bowles, Mihir Nagarkatti	The House Book (the Butler's), The empty vial
Markers 18 to 22 belong to the five who escaped	Rebecca Chow, Leon Gee, Joshua Kamin-Sky	The List: Roll of Placements, Cassie's roll

Fact the guests must piece together	Held by (lines on their cards)	Printed pages
Kit prepared the List of twenty-two	Ananya Codru and Charlie Wakem, Molly Daniel, Rebecca Chow	The List: Roll of Placements, The October wire, “Anniversary notices withdrawn”
Five of the twenty-two survived	Sheriff Theodor Farrago, Dr. Emmerich Sunner, Molly Daniel, Leon Gee	Cassie's roll, “Anniversary notices withdrawn”, The List: Roll of Placements
(to be rewritten) who sent the invitations	Ananya Codru and Charlie Wakem, Molly Daniel, Luke Shelldon, Leon Gee	The October wire, A loose note: “not mine”, Cassie's roll
(to be rewritten) what Kit came for	Anika Mahns, Joshua Kamin-Sky, Adam Holdsfire	Books, extract 1923, Memorandum: the vault, Rent counterfoils, A loose note: “not mine”

New or changed clues I have to add: the House's asks (the Succession, seven partial lines); the old man's jacket note, rewritten as "I sent them. Every one of them owes me, and I know why."; the Roll of the Veil, a parchment with 19 signature lines on the black table; and the "who sent the invitations" fact, split in two. Jack's lines (a grey Hudson sold to Quill) move to Krrish.

Printed pages (existing): the List, Quill's receipts, the 1923 books, the vault memorandum, the three forged orders, rent counterfoils, the loose note, the nightcap chart, the 1 November Farrago; held by guests: Cassie's Christmas card, the October wire, the torn register page, Cassie's roll, the boarding-house page, the House Book, the memorial notices, the coroner's report; at the scene: the pocket watch, the empty vial, the rail stub.

7. The receipts

	Fake (on the wall, three)	Real (under the portrait, one)
What it says	"Received of Miss C. Castello, twenty dollars, in advance, for the killing of one name on the Veil's roll, as directed. To be done quietly." Dated 8 Nov 1924, 5 Dec 1924, 19 Jan 1925	"Paid in full by C.C., in gold, to get five persons safely out of Manchester alive: a new name, papers and a fare for each. The holders of markers 18, 19, 20, 21 and 22. Names withheld." Dated 2 Nov 1924
What it implies	Cassie paid for the killings	Cassie saved the five, so she is no killer, and she was alive after the "massacre"
How a guest can tell	Drawn on the Merchants' Trust, Boston (the Keeper's bank). Every i has a ring. A smudged embossing mark under the "C."	Plain dots on every i, like her Christmas card (Rebecca) and her roll (Leon). No bank. Paid in gold
Who can crack it	Anthony (saw the rings in court), Rebecca (the card), Leon, Ananya	Whoever finds it

8. The wall around Cassie's portrait

Printable pages: `docs/print/wall-of-cassie.pdf` (page 1 is hanging instructions) and `real-receipt-under-portrait.pdf` (hide this one).

The Evening Farrago front page (Terror at the Black Veil, "Massacre," Say Guests); the police bulletin (person of interest, no warrant); three unsigned closure notices for three different places; three fake receipts; a singed admission card; a nameless vigil card; the portrait plate ("Cassandra Castello, Proprietress, The Black Veil, 1921 –", no end date); an unsigned handwritten note tucked in the frame ("They have not forgotten you. Neither have I."); a torn 1923 books page with names blacked out; and the real receipt under the portrait.

9. Objects

Hidden finds (18 needed, 20 covered): brass candlestick (the Veil candle), jack-o'-lantern, golden elephant on the book, conch shell, African mask sculpture, candy jar, cardinal ornament (moved off the lamp), cake dome, octopus candle stand, wooden duck, globe, Falstaff poster, beaded lamp, red desk lamp, chess box with the white rook (a tiny "2" taped under it: the second door), pocket Constitution, pocket Bill of Rights, the broken record player, golden dumbbell, lit-up wine bottle, kosher salt box, and the back of the portrait.

Carried (12, by swap pair): Anika (metal spoon) and Krrish (the key); Rhea (napkin) and Tim (the little jar); Angelos (casino chip) and Luke (giraffe whittling); Erika (printed false papers) and Ananya (printed telegram form); Josh (something you will find) and Tiffany (an earring); Arjun (baseball) and Adam (the little brown box).

Role props: Theodor's black cowboy hat, badge and handcuffs; the Doctor's bag; the Butler's House Tin (the small round tin), House Book and one real vial. The oil bottles hold water only: empty the essential oils and fill them with water. Labelled decoys: camphor, hartshorn, wintergreen.

The jacket: the dead man's jacket holds the pocket watch stopped at 11:47, the rail stub and his note, and, sewn or taped inside the lining where only a searcher will find it, the secret tie-breaker stub (Manchester to Boston, 11:12 PM).

Not used: martini glasses, trumpet photo, merlot, shears, plates, orange slices, holy water, the decanters, the Nikon (Molly gets a paper press card). Take the cannabis items and anything modern off the tables before guests arrive.

10. Secrets (approved)

Each is gossip a second guest can earn, and each is one small piece of one clue, never a whole one.

Character	The secret	The piece it feeds
Anika	Wears her father's brass key on a ribbon and has never tried it in a lock	The vault needs the Silent Partner's key
Joel	His "office" is the back room of a hat shop, and the Keeper once used its telephone to call Boston	Fitch & Fitch, the Keeper's lawyers
Mihir	The "gusher" was a burst water main, and he lost a bet to the Keeper over it	The nine o'clock rye with honey
Rhea	Sold the House its last bottle of nux vomica and rang it up as "river rats"	The poison came from the House
Theodor	Keeps a shoebox with seventeen "accidents" in it	Seventeen died, never connected
Eric	Let three "orders in C.C.'s hand" stand although the clerk swore the i's had rings	The orders were forged
Anthony	Drew name-change papers for a dozen strangers, paid in gold, and kept the carbon	The Exit gave people new names
Emmerich	Ate beet sandwiches for a week to prove the "blood" was beets and sugar	The massacre was staged
Molly	Kept the line the city desk would not print: no coroner, no ambulance	The massacre was staged
Leon	Read "I am well" items on air for two months and thought they were a lonely-hearts code	Cassie is alive
Ananya	Once filed a Montreal telegram, paid in advance, no sender	The wire came from Montreal
Luke	Built stage blood for a "private masquerade" billed to a post-office box	The massacre was staged

Character	The secret	The piece it feeds
Silas	Has sung the same scat phrase at every club since 1921: it was Cassie's own call	Leon's signal is hers
Josh	Read tea leaves off half-burned pages swept from an empty flue	"C. is out. K. holds the books."
Arjun	Hauled bricks in 1921 for a wall in the Merrimack Room that is too thick	A vault behind the window
Adam	Sold six boxes of blanks to a lady's agent for cash and never asked why	The massacre was staged
Tiffany	Cut the brass plate "KEEPER · K.K." and her chisel slipped on the second K	The old man is Kit Kessler
Diwakar	Was paid to take a fall on Halloween 1924 and told to stay down until the music stopped	The music stopped at 11:47
Tim	Two passengers went down the river steps; one came back alone with blood on his cuff	Kit ambushed Cassie at the launch
Rebecca	The House whiskey is cold tea, and she took $200 to forget Room 3	Cassie hid wounded at her house
Angelos	Knows the Keeper touches his watch when he bluffs, and it has not run since 1924	The watch stopped at 11:47
Erika	Bought a name at the river steps for $20 and was told at least twenty others did too	The Exit
Sidd	Trained a mechanic who was later paid to be careless once	The aeroplane crash was no accident
Krrish	Delivered a crate of wine in November 1924 on a draft signed K. Kessler to a grey Hudson that later turned up in the river	The hitman's car

11. The five survivors: your pick is Mihir, Rhea, Adam, Anthony and Molly

How it works. Each survivor gets Cassie's unsigned invitation and a numbered marker (18 to 22) and knows only that they survived and must end the old man. Their own reason for wanting him dead is an errand they work out. They keep their find and swap and replace the other errands with the same chain: learn the hour and who holds the vial, make an offer to the Butler, and work out why. Everyone's total stays 60. Whoever the Butler sells to first is the killer, and the killer is one point above the other survivors. Everyone may name up to five guests at the end.

What needs to adjust with your five:

1. **Groups.** Mihir and Rhea are both in The Gilded, and The River Trade has no survivor. Fix: move Rhea to the River Trade (she already stocks Tim's gin as a "tonic" in her back room). Then it is one each: Gilded Mihir, Order Anthony, Stage Molly (The Wire & the Stage: Molly, Leon, Ananya, Luke, Silas, the performers and the people who carry news), Working Adam, River Rhea. Group sizes become Gilded 4, Order 4, Stage 5, Working 5, River 6, which does not matter for the overall winner.
2. **Identities.** The five real identities were written for other trades (the Teller, the Notary, the Maestro, the Doorman, the Wren). Mihir is the Teller and Anthony is the Notary, and both fit. Adam fits the Doorman (a gunsmith who knows who holds which door). Rhea and Molly need new trades on the List. My suggestion: Rhea is the Milliner, the Veil's costume mistress (masks, gowns), and Molly is the Runner, who carried the Veil's mail and late editions. What the Keeper took from each of them has to be written for those two, and their tells.
3. **Molly's deal.** She was in the leak deal with Eric. Eric gets a new one with Krrish: Krrish sends the Judge a crate of wine every Friday and the Judge quietly dismisses his cases (a bribe, neither may admit it). I chose Krrish rather than Tim so nothing depends on Tim coming.
4. **Anthony.** He currently holds the clue "I noticed the rings in court." As the Notary who forged the orders he cannot be the witness, so that line moves to Eric.

5. **Clues to rebuild.** The identity clues (the tell, the crack, the cover, the motive) for all five, because they were written for the old five. The checker has to be re-run.
6. **Unchanged:** Rhea and Tim's swap and Adam and Arjun's swap stay as they are, since survivors keep their swap.

What changes for the guests, and what does not. Nothing already published changes. Every character's public name, role and background on the site stays exactly as it is. The survivor layer (a real 1924 name and trade, the tell, the grievance, the marker) is private and only added to the five cards. The group a character is in is internal and is not shown on the site.

If someone cannot come. Characters only appear on the guest list while their guest is registered and coming, so a guest who drops out leaves no hole on the site. For the game itself, a guest who cannot come is marked "did not come" in the staff page, and the hand-offs are covered. **Tim in particular:** nothing is built on him. His only link is Rhea's swap, and in that case you stand in for him at the bar: you hold the little jar and Rhea trades with you. I moved Eric's deal to Krrish for exactly this. His clue lines are each held by at least three other guests, and his secret is known by Krrish and Rebecca, so it can still be learned. The same stand-in rule covers any other absence.

12. Misleading trails (red herrings)

Yes, and they are on purpose. Each has a clue that clears it, held by at least two other guests, so the game stays solvable.

Points the finger at	The misleading thing	What clears it
Cassie, overall	The three forged orders "in her hand," the three fake receipts on the wall, the Farrago's "massacre," the police bulletin, the closure notices	The ringed i's versus her plain hand (the Christmas card, her roll), the Keeper's bank on the receipts, the real receipt under the portrait
The Butler	She sold the vial (the House Book), found the body, took $200 to forget Room 3, and her alibi for 9:15 was bought from Erika	The vial was sold against a marker numbered 18 to 22 and the Butler holds no marker. The alibi deal is just her business
The Doctor	Strychnine is a medicine, his bag holds a bottle of "tonic," and he was alone with the body	The coroner's report says the vial was the House's stock, not a druggist's pack. His bottle is still full and sealed
The Sheriff	He may take Leon's bribe, holds the Coroner's Folder, was first on the scene, keeps a shoebox of "accidents," and carries handcuffs	He holds no marker and has no motive. The folder matches the scene
Anika	She has the Silent Partner's key and the money, and her 8:30 deal with Silas looks like she is planning something	The deal is about who knew her father
Habit decoys	The code has six innocent guests who share a survivor's habit (the tell). They have to be rewritten for the new five	Each decoy has a "vouch" line held by three others

13. The night

Time	What
Afternoon	Hide the 18 hidden finds, lay out the black table (the Binder, nightcap chart, a glass on a coaster with a code underneath, the Roll of the Veil, the black cloth), hang the wall, set the House Tin and House Book at the bar, give Rebecca the vial
7:55	The Private tab opens
8:00	Doors. Brief card and rules card on the door. Cocktails. Errands begin
8:30	Silas's five-minute spotlight (Anika's deal)

Time	What
About 8:35	You stage the old man in the chair section, with the glass, tape and scene pages
9:00	The House closes. Nightcap served
9:15	Rebecca finds him and screams. The Sheriff takes charge, the Doctor examines
9:15 to 10:15	Investigation. No town hall. The Sheriff names an arrest by 10:15
10:00	Wrap-up: gather everyone and read Cassie's letter
10:05	Music flips to 2026
10:30	The book closes. Grading

(The old man is staged dead from before the 9:15 scream; the Succession is what he planned for half past nine.)

14. What you will print today, and what is left

Ready: the wall pages, the real receipt.

Now that you have picked the survivors, I generate (after you confirm section 11): 24 character cards (public, background, private), the five survivors' envelopes (marker and Cassie's unsigned invitation), the 19 House invitations with the seven private asks, every printed exhibit with its filing code, the Roll of the Veil, the 18 hidden-find tags and 12 carried-item tags, the brief card and rules card for the door, the Butler's House Book, the nightcap chart, and a drink menu if you tell me what you are pouring.

What I have to change in the game code first (when you say go): Krrish in and Jack out; the Succession plan and the House's asks; Questions A and B; the split invitation question; the unsigned invitation; the affair, pardon, deals and alibi; the real objects; the secrets above; the killer bonus; the five survivors; then re-run the checker and the tests.